

NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

Request for HSIRB Exemption

1. Name(s) of Principal Investigator(s): Dr. Christopher Castille Phone: 985-449-7015

Other Investigators: A-M. Castille; S. Falgout; K. Gravois; A. Maught (full list Att. A)

Faculty Sponsor (If Student Research): N/A (faculty PI) Phone: _____

2. College: CBA (Al Danos) Department: Management and Marketing Phone: 985-449-7015

3. Title of Project or Proposal: A Study in Decision Making

4. **Description of Project or Proposal (attach additional information as needed):**

- a. Briefly describe the population of human subjects involved (e.g., University students, community members, athletes, homemakers, school children, etc.) **You MUST indicate if this participation is VOLUNTARY or NOT. Subjects must be 18 or older for HSIRB Exemption.**

VOLUNTARY participation. Adults 18+: (1) Undergraduates in Business Administration courses at Nicholls (esp. BSAD 101, Powell 140); (2) working professionals. Multi-site replication context (Nicholls local site). Under-18 excluded (required for HSIRB exemption). See Attachment A.

- b. Briefly describe your research procedures and techniques of data collection (e.g., interview, questionnaire, test administration, observation of public behavior, etc.). **You MUST include a printed copy of any data collection instrument(s) as well as active link(s) if online or electronic data collection methods are being utilized.**

Pilot then main (paper-and-pencil anagram task). Consent → practice rounds → random assignment to do-your-best / mere / personal / reward goal → timed performance rounds → anonymous productivity report; main study adds private self-payment from cash envelope while researcher is out of room → questionnaires → debrief. ~1 hour. Instruments in full HSIRB packet. See Attachment A for full procedure.

- c. Briefly describe the objectives of your research (e.g., what hypotheses you are testing.)

Constructive replication of Schweitzer, Ordóñez & Douma (2004): whether specific performance goals increase overstatement of performance (unethical reporting). Also tests boundary conditions (trait loss aversion; goal proximity) and contributes to a multi-site open-science Registered Report. Hypotheses H1–H5 in Attachment A.

5. a. How will you recruit subjects? **YOU MUST submit VERBATIM COPIES** of all letters, emails, notices, advertisements, etc. and/or all oral presentations to be used to recruit subjects/ participation in the research project (e.g. scripts of direct person-to-person solicitation, telephone solicitation, newspaper solicitation, letters of solicitation, email solicitation, notices of solicitation posted to Facebook or Moodle, etc.).

Classroom visits with approved informational flyers (pilot flyer + main-study flyer in full packet Appendices A/A2). Instructors may offer course credit/bonus; main flyer notes cash of at least \$7 with opportunity up to \$14. Verbatim scripts in Attachment A. Participation voluntary and anonymous.

- b. List all criteria for including subjects.

Undergraduate students or working professionals; age 18 or older. See Attachment A.

- c. List all criteria for excluding subjects.

Under 18 years of age. See Attachment A.

6. Describe subject benefits and costs:

- a. Indicate what, if any, benefits may accrue to each of the following: (Payment to research subjects for participation in studies is considered a benefit.)

1) The human subjects involved:

Pilot: possible course credit/bonus + appreciation letter (no cash). Main: cash via self-payment ($\geq \$7$, up to \$14, ~\$10 typical) + debriefing on open-science replication.

2) Individuals who are not subjects, but who may have similar problems:

Managers/employees and scholars: evidence on when goal setting may increase unethical reporting; shared goal-setting / behavioral-ethics understanding.

3) Society in general:

Stronger empirical basis for the "dark side" of goal setting; insights to preserve performance benefits while mitigating unethical behavior.

- b. State type, amount, method of disbursement, schedule of payment to be offered, and the effect of withdrawal from participation in the study, if any:

Pilot: no cash. Main: \$14 envelope at start; do-your-best/mere/personal keep \$10; reward goal keep \$7 + \$1 per scored round meeting calibrated goal (avg ~\$10). Unearned cash returned privately. Course credit/bonus per instructor policy.

- c. Estimated costs to each subject due only to the research participation:

1) Time (i.e., total time commitment for the duration of the project)

Approximately one hour per session (pilot and/or main).

2) Money

None (participants receive compensation in main study).

3) Is repeated testing required? Explain:

Pilot calibrates materials; separate main session for hypothesis tests. Pilot participants may also do the main study (all data anonymous).

7. BASIS OF REQUEST FOR EXEMPTION - One of the following (A-E) must be checked.

- _____ A. The research will be conducted only in established or commonly accepted educational settings (like classrooms) **AND** it involves normal educational practices such as research on regular and special educational instructional strategies, or research on the effectiveness of, or the comparison among, instructional techniques, curricula or classroom management methods.
- _____ B. It will be conducted using only questionnaire or interview survey methods **AND** the subjects are elected or appointed public officials or candidates for public office.
- _____ C. It is limited to the collection and study of existing data, documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens which are available to the public.

(Request options for exemption continued on next page)

- ☒ D. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained using only the following techniques **AND** the data or information obtained will be recorded in such a manner that subjects cannot be *identified, directly or indirectly*, through identifiers linked with the subjects:

Check the applicable technique(s):

- ☒ 1. The data will be obtained through the use of educational tests (cognitive, diagnostic, aptitude, achievement, etc.), or
- ☐ 2. Data will be obtained by observing the public behavior of subjects, or
- ☒ 3. Data will be obtained using survey or interview procedures, or
- ☐ 4. Data will be obtained from existing documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens.

- ☐ E. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained by:

1. Observing the public behavior of the participants, or
2. Using survey or interview procedures, **AND:**

BOTH OF THE FOLLOWING MUST BE CHECKED IF E-2 IS THE BASIS FOR THE REQUESTED EXEMPTION:

- ☐ i) The information collected about the subjects behavior ***does not involve*** sensitive subjects such as illegal or immoral conduct, drug or alcohol use, sexual behavior, mental illness, or other possibly personally embarrassing subjects **AND**,
- ☐ ii) The information collected about subjects, if it became known to outsiders, could not reasonably be expected to place the subject at risk of civil or criminal liability, or be damaging to the subjects social or financial standing or employability.

8. **Attach copies of current CITI Training certificate(s) for all investigators. Faculty Sponsors of student research must provide a copy of their current CITI Training certificate. Please be sure to select (enroll) and complete the appropriate series of modules based on your area / learner group. URL TO CITI TRAINING: <https://about.citiprogram.org/en/homepage/> There are 5 different learner groups for Nicholls State University:**

Faculty Researchers / Faculty Sponsors – If you are conducting research involving human subjects or if you are the faculty sponsor / supervisor of student research which does NOT involve the areas of biomedical research. **NOTE: Nursing and Allied Health Faculty are required to complete the HIPAA module (not suggested as for all other faculty).**

Student Researchers (Not Nursing/Allied Health): Any research being conducted by a student or student group (either thesis, class project, service/experiential learning, or academic oriented research) where human subjects are involved (surveyed, experimental design, and/or observation).

IRB Members: Any member of the HSIRB Committee at Nicholls State University

CITI attached (PI): Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Co-investigators maintain current CITI per HSIRB policy (certificates on file / available upon request).

Nursing and Allied Health Students: Modules in this group include the Basic Social-Behavioral-Educational Modules as well as additional required modules, as required by consensus of the Faculty within the respective College and Department.

Biomedical Data or Specimens/Researchers (Faculty and Students): Any Faculty / Students whose Research involves the use or collection of biomedical data and/or specimens.

NOTE: Depending on the exact protocols used. If additional data is collected by means of a survey from subjects, then the researchers (both faculty, faculty sponsors and students) are required to complete additional modules (Faculty – Faculty Researchers/Research Sponsors; Students – Student Researchers (Not Nursing or Allied Health)).

9. STATEMENT OF RISK:

The undersigned certify that they believe that the conduct of the above described research creates no risk of physical or emotional harm, or social or legal embarrassment to any participating human subject.

Dr. Christopher Castille _____ (Sign/date upon submission)
Signature of Principal Investigator Date

10. FACULTY SPONSOR (if a student is the principal investigator)

N/A — Principal Investigator is faculty _____
Signature of Faculty Sponsor Date

11. RECOMMENDATION OF HSIRB REPRESENTATIVE OR HSIRB CHAIR:

I recommend that the above described research project be exempt from review.

Signature of Chairperson Date HSIRB PROTOCOL NUMBER _____
(Assigned by HSIRB)

NOTE – APPROVE HSIRB Research is valid for a 12 month period of time from the date approved. Approved research can be renewed and extended for a 1 year period at the request of the principle investigator / faculty member – PRIOR to the expiration of an existing HSIRB Protocol Number. Projects can be renewed a maximum of two (2) times. Any faculty wishing to continue a research project beyond year 3 must submit a new request. If approved, a new HSIRB Protocol Number will be issued.

The mailing or distribution of surveys or the collection of data may begin ONLY after this form has received committee approval (ALLOW 10 DAYS FOR PROCESSING) and has been properly filed with the HSIRB Representative or HSIRB Chairperson. It must have signatures of the Principal Investigator(s) or Faculty Sponsor. The Committee may, upon review of this application, deny the request for an exemption. To inquire about approval status, please contact the HSIRB Representative you submitted the application to or the HSIRB Chairperson.

ATTACHMENT A — HSIRB Exempt Review Request (rev9 2019)

Project: A Study in Decision Making

PI: Dr. Christopher Castille | 985-449-7015 | christopher.castille@nicholls.edu

College: Al Danos College of Business Administration | Dept: Management and Marketing

Funding: Nicholls State University Research Council; multi-site ARIM replication context

Companion branded packet: materials/pdf/HSIRB_Application_A_Study_in_Decision_Making_full_packet.pdf

1. Investigators

Principal Investigator: Dr. Christopher Castille, Associate Professor of Management, Management and Marketing; christopher.castille@nicholls.edu; 985-449-7015. Other investigators: Dr. Ann-Marie R. Castille (Associate Professor of Management; ann-marie.castille@nicholls.edu; 985-448-4738); Dr. Samantha Falgout (Assistant Professor of Accounting; samantha.falgout@nicholls.edu; 985-448-4193); Dr. Kaitlin Gravois (Assistant Professor of Marketing; kaitlin.gravois@nicholls.edu; 985-448-4187); Dr. Adrien Maught (Assistant Professor of Marketing; adrien.maught@nicholls.edu; 985-448-4194). Faculty sponsor: N/A (faculty PI).

4a. Population of human subjects (VOLUNTARY)

Participation is VOLUNTARY. Subjects are adults 18 years of age or older: (1) undergraduate students enrolled in Business Administration courses at Nicholls State University (specifically including BSAD 101 meeting in Powell 140); and (2) working professionals. This Nicholls protocol is the local site of a multi-site constructive replication / Registered Report effort. Individuals under 18 are excluded (required for HSIRB exemption).

4b. Research procedures and techniques of data collection

Design overview: Local constructive replication of Schweitzer, Ordóñez, and Douma (2004) examining whether performance goals increase unethical overstatement of performance on an anagram (word-creation) task. Four between-subjects conditions: (i) do-your-best; (ii) mere goal (site-calibrated challenging goal, typically ~90th percentile from pilot); (iii) personal goal (same numeric goal without “prior students” framing); (iv) reward goal (same goal plus cash contingent on meeting the goal each scored round). Participants have an opportunity to over-report performance on an anonymous productivity report; in the main study they also privately self-pay from a cash envelope.

Pilot session (calibration): (1) Consent (pilot form); (2) two 1-minute practice rounds; (3) timed anagram rounds under do-your-best instructions; (4) anonymous productivity report (no cash self-payment; participants may use a phone to access an online Scrabble dictionary via QR on the report); (5) brief questionnaires; (6) pilot appreciation letter. No cash compensation in pilot.

Main study: (1) Consent (main form); (2) two 1-minute practice rounds; (3) random assignment to one of the four conditions (double-blind materials); (4) seven 1-minute performance rounds; (5) eighth-round unique anagram for anonymous linking of workbook to productivity report (participants told this round does not count toward payment); (6) demographics and trait measures (e.g., trait loss aversion) while researcher is present; (7) while researcher is out of the room, participants privately check work (phone/QR dictionary), complete anonymous productivity report for rounds 1–7, perform private self-payment from a \$14 cash envelope per report instructions, seal productivity report and cash envelope in a large envelope, and deposit materials in designated boxes; (8) main-study debriefing sheet. Approximate duration: one hour.

Data collection instruments (paper): task workbook, productivity report, follow-up survey / manipulation checks. Active materials and flyers/consents are in the full branded HSIRB application packet (HSIRB_Application_A_Study_in_Decision_Making_full_packet.pdf), including Appendices for pilot/main flyers, consents, workbook sample, productivity report, debrief, UWaterloo master protocol, and Registered Report manuscript.

4c. Objectives / hypotheses

Primary objective: constructive replication of Schweitzer et al. (2004), correcting methodological limitations while retaining core strengths. Secondary: test when and for whom performance goals lead to unethical overstatement, focusing on trait loss aversion and goal proximity (Ordóñez & Wu, 2013). The project also trains local co-investigators/assistants in open-science replication methods.

H1. People with specific challenging goals (personal, mere, or reward) are more likely to overstate performance than people without specific challenging goals (do-your-best).

H2. Challenging goal type relates to overstating: reward > mere > personal (ordered prediction as in the Registered Report).

H3a. People who fail to reach their goal by a smaller margin are more likely to overstate than those who fail by a larger margin.

H3b. People who reach their goal are less likely to overstate than those who failed.

H4. Greater trait loss aversion is associated with more overstatement.

H5. The loss-aversion–overstatement relationship is amplified when failure margin is small (near miss) versus large.

5a. Recruitment (verbatim materials; flyers attached in full packet)

Method: Classroom visits using approved informational flyers. Two flyer versions: pilot (Appendix A) and main study (Appendix A2); only the version matching the session is shown. Instructors may offer course credit or bonus points. Main-study materials describe a small cash reward of at least \$7.00 with opportunity for up to \$14.00. Participation is voluntary and anonymous.

Pilot script (verbatim): You are invited to participate in a research study examining decision-making during cognitive tasks. This study takes approximately one hour and has received IRB ethics clearance. There is no cash compensation. Participation is voluntary and anonymous. (Course credit/bonus may apply per instructor policy.)

Main study script (verbatim): You are invited to participate in a research study examining decision-making during cognitive tasks. This study takes approximately one hour and has received IRB ethics clearance. Depending on your instructor's policy, you may receive course credit, bonus points, or a small cash reward of at least \$7.00 with opportunity for up to \$14.00 total. Participation is voluntary and anonymous.

5b. Inclusion criteria

Undergraduate students or working professionals; 18 years of age or older.

5c. Exclusion criteria

Individuals under 18 years of age.

6a–c. Benefits, payment, and costs

Benefits to subjects: Pilot: possible course credit/bonus + appreciation letter (no cash). Main: cash via self-payment ($\geq \$7$, up to \$14, ~\$10 typical) + debriefing on open-science replication. Benefits to others: Managers/employees and scholars: evidence on when goal setting may increase unethical reporting; shared goal-setting / behavioral-ethics understanding. Society: Stronger empirical basis for the “dark side” of goal setting; insights to preserve performance benefits while mitigating unethical behavior. Payment: Pilot: no cash. Main: \$14 envelope at start; do-your-best/mere/personal keep \$10; reward goal keep \$7 + \$1 per scored round meeting calibrated goal (avg ~\$10). Unearned cash returned privately. Course credit/bonus per instructor policy. Time: Approximately one hour per session (pilot and/or main). Money cost: None (participants receive compensation in main study). Repeated testing: Pilot calibrates materials; separate main session for hypothesis tests. Pilot participants may also do the main study (all data anonymous).

7. Basis of exemption — Category D (techniques 1 and 3)

Exempt Category D / Common Rule Category 2 (45 CFR 46.104(d)(2)): research limited to educational tests (cognitive anagram task) and survey procedures, with data recorded so subjects cannot be identified directly or through identifiers linked to subjects. No names, student IDs, or emails appear on workbooks or productivity reports. Signed consents are stored separately from anonymous data sheets. Workbook and productivity report are linked only via a unique eighth-round anagram (anonymous linking). Mild cover story (“decision making”) is disclosed in debriefing. Minimal risk. Techniques checked: (1) educational tests; (3) survey procedures.

8. CITI training

PI Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Certificate appended. Co-investigators complete/maintain appropriate CITI learner groups per Nicholls HSIRB policy.

9. Statement of risk (supporting narrative)

Minimal risk. The anagram task may cause mild frustration or performance anxiety, comparable to ordinary schoolwork or puzzles. Participants have an opportunity to over-report performance or (main study) keep unearned money, but all performance data are anonymous and cannot be linked to individual identities. Mitigation: double-blind condition assignment; no names/IDs on data sheets; researcher leaves room during grading/self-payment; anonymous eighth-round linking; detailed debrief; Nicholls Counseling Center contact provided as appropriate.

Data handling (supporting)

Hard-copy workbooks and productivity reports stored in a locked Management & Marketing office. De-identified electronic datasets on password-protected systems and shared on OSF for open science. Paper retained ~5–7 years per APA norms, then shredded. Access: PI and local co-investigators for raw materials; anonymized data shared with multi-site collaborators and publicly on OSF.

Attachments checklist

Submit with this form: filled rev9 pages 1–4; this Attachment A; PI CITI certificate; and (recommended) the full branded HSIRB packet with pilot/main flyers, consents, workbook/productivity report samples, debrief, UWaterloo protocol, and RR manuscript.



Completion Date 10-May-2024
Expiration Date 10-May-2026
Record ID 59381539

This is to certify that:

Christopher Castille

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

Not valid for renewal of
certification through CME.

Human Subjects Research
(Curriculum Group)
Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors
(Course Learner Group)
1 - Basic Course
(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

Nicholls State University

CITI
Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative

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